

OVERCALLS

East opens 1♣, 1♦, 1♥, or 1♠ (NOT 1NT). South — sitting next — makes a simple non-jump overcall.

Requirements for South:

- 5+ cards in a side suit (NOT the same suit East opened)
- 8+ HCP at the 1-level (e.g., 1♣ — 1♥)
- 11+ HCP at the 2-level (e.g., 1♥ — 2♣)
- NOT a takeout-double hand (this scenario excludes 4-4-4-1 / 4-4-3-2

takeout shapes — those go to Basic_Takeout_Double instead)

- NO weak jump overcalls (the filter excludes jumps; this is a NATURAL

one-level-higher overcall only)

For beginners: an overcall says "I have a real suit and some values." With a 5-card suit and 8+ HCP, lead-direction and obstruction are both served. Don't overcall on weaker hands — partner will assume values.

Reference: <https://www.bridgebum.com/overcalls.php> 4NT is Blackwood, asking for aces, or quantitative (inviting 6NT) after a natural notrump bid. Responses:

- 5♣ = 0 or 4 aces
- 5♦ = 1 ace
- 5♥ = 2 aces
- 5♠ = 3 aces
- 5NT then asks for kings the same way